

From Bergelmir came a new race of giants – some fair, others monstrous. They lived in a land called Jotunheim and became the gods' most hated enemy.

Odin shaped a new world from Ymir's gigantic body. The salt seas and freshwater lakes he made with Ymir's blood; trees from his hair; mountains from his bones; stones from his teeth, and the earth from his flesh. For the sky Odin cracked open Ymir's skull and raised it high, placing four dwarfs called East, West, North and South at the corners to hold it up. Odin then formed rainclouds by casting Ymir's brains into the brand-new sky, and the stars he made by scattering sparks born in the fires of Muspelheim. Finally he built a land called Midgard – Middle Earth – and surrounded it with a high wall using Ymir's huge, curving eyelashes. His work – for now – was complete.

*... and a new world
emerged from
Ymir's body.*

